

What is the prognosis?

Last revised in March 2025

- **With optimal management, people with type 2 diabetes can live a normal life, but are at risk of multiple complications (</topics/diabetes-type-2/background-information/complications/>) long term.**
 - Insulin deficiency in type 2 diabetes progresses with time and usually worsens over a period of years [[NICE, 2020a](#) (</topics/diabetes-type-2/references/>)].
 - The International Society for Pediatric and Adolescent Diabetes (ISPAD) guidelines note that type 2 diabetes diagnosed in young people is characterized by rapid onset and progression, with more common and progressive co-morbidities (such as fatty liver disease and sleep apnoea), and more rapid development of microvascular complications and cardiovascular risk than adult-onset type 2 diabetes, leading to increased morbidity and mortality rates [[Zeitler, 2018](#) (</topics/diabetes-type-2/references/>)].
 - The World Health Organization notes that young-onset type 2 diabetes is associated with greater mortality rates, more complications, and increased cardiovascular disease risk factors than for people with type 1 diabetes of similar duration [[WHO, 2019](#) (</topics/diabetes-type-2/references/>)].

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